Where the Irish go for St. Pat's day

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The Tribune

A Combined Communications newspaper

Friday afternoon/March 16, 1979/Oakland, California/20¢

GGF Handicap/Final Stocks

1,160 teachers get layoff warnings

Some 1,160 Eastbay teachers received bad news yesterday, the deadline for school districts to notify them of possible layoffs or reassignments in the fall.

Notices, prompted by shrunken post-Prop. 13 school budgets, were sent in 18 of the 28 school districts in Alameda and Contra Costa counties. The Mt. Diablo Unified School District sent out 250 letters, more than any other single district.

Notifying a high percentage of teachers were Livermore, which sent the notices to 121 of its 600 teachers; Martinez, with notices to 74 of its 215 teachers, and Pittsburg, where notices went to 110 of the district's 380 teachers.

About 140 notices went out in San Ramon, 90 in Castro Valley, 65 in Hayward, 45 in Newark and 28 in San Leandro.

No layoff notices were sent in such large districts as Oakland, with more than 2,000 teachers; Richmond, with 1,500 teachers; Fremont, with 1,300, and Berkeley, with 700.

About half the school employees who got letters will probably keep their jobs, estimated Loren Gammon of the California Teachers Association, "but still they have to go through all this trouble and worry.

"I've seen some teachers go through it three or four years in a row. Because of low seniority, they get kicked out of one district and then are cut from another one. People used to think of teaching as a fairly stable job. Not any more."

Oakland's school board decided at almost the last minute to send no notices. Instead it will rely on hiring and purchasing freezes to meet an estimated $8 million deficit.

The Fremont district faces a $1.3 million deficit and just Wednesday night granted pay raises to teachers and other school employees in accord with the state Supreme Court decision that voided a state-imposed pay freeze. But rather than lay off teachers it will join with other districts to urge the state Legislature for relief funds.

Although the Berkeley district sent no layoff notices, the school board proposed lengthening the class time of teachers from 32.5 to 37.5 hours a week and prohibiting elementary school teachers from using the bathroom during recess time, and requiring attendance at school open houses and meetings of the PTA and other functions.

In districts where letters were sent, administrators said they hope most of the layoffs will be avoided. But until their budgets are completed, they must allow for maximum flexibility, they said.

Their hopes lie in natural attrition as teachers resign or retire, in declining enrollments and in financial aid from the state.

Continued back page, col. 1

EVERYONE OFF—BART evacuated almost 1,000 volunteer passengers from a train stopped in the transbay tube last night in one more test of the system's improved firefighting procedures. See story, Page 11.

Jetliner hijacked—suspect nabbed

Associated Press

Tucson, Ariz.—A man demanding $200,000 and transportation to Havana hijacked a Continental Airlines Boeing 727 jetliner on a flight from Phoenix to Tucson today, the airline said. Authorities said he was taken into custody about two hours later at the airport and no one was hurt.

"He is under arrest and nobody was harmed," said FBI agent Jim Yellington in Phoenix.

When the plane had landed at Tucson International Airport, everyone but a female flight attendant and the hijacker got off, according to Continental spokesman Jack Gregory in Los Angeles.

The flight attendant, identified as Mary Ellen Paul, of Los Angeles, was later freed unharmed.

The plane had carried 89 passengers.

Gregory said an FBI agent had boarded the plane at the airport.

A reporter at the airport said he saw a man in an orange vest stand on the roof of a police car at the nose of the plane and pull himself up through the cockpit window.

FBI agent Leon M. Gaskill identified the man they arrested as John Carleton Kivlen, 52, of San Rafael, Calif. He said the only thing the man had resembling a weapon was a nail file.

Gaskill said Kivlen was arrested without incident after the flight attendant locked herself in a lavatory on the plane.

Earlier, FBI agents were seen lying underneath the tail of the plane attempting to negotiate with the hijacker.

A reporter for the Tucson Citizen said the pilot and co-pilot fled through the cockpit windows.

The plane, Flight 62, was bound for Miami. It had left Phoenix at 9:15 a.m. MST and arrived at Tucson at 9:40 a.m.

One of the passengers, Richard Paul, 38, of Los Angeles, a television actor who played the mayor on the ABC series "Carter Country," said that while the plane was between Phoenix and Tucson, the pilot came on the intercom and asked all passengers to get off at Tucson.

"His voice was shaking," Paul said. "That bothered me. It always bothers me when the man in charge has a shaking voice."

A third passenger, Bob Cook, from Tucson, said the man was carrying a shaving kit and had been sitting in the front of the coach section during the flight.

"I didn't know what was happening until we landed, and when I saw a crash truck come out I knew something was going on," Cook said.

Cook said that after the plane landed, the hijacker stood in midplane in the galley holding his shaving kit with a stewardess behind him.

Slaying suspect asks for two juries

Associated Press

Santa Monica—The attorney for John William Zimmerman, a 29-year-old roofer accused of slaying two members of a Santa Monica family, asked for two juries for his trial.

Deputy public defender Edgar Gilmore said yesterday that one jury would decide Zimmerman's guilt or innocence and the other would consider whether the death penalty should be recommended if Zimmerman is convicted.

New hike in gas price threatened

Associated Press

If Nigeria acts on its announced desire to raise crude oil prices by 17 percent on April 1 it could trigger similar action by other oil producers and increase U.S. gasoline prices an additional three cents, analysts say.

The African nation's statement yesterday came as a survey by the Lundberg Letter, an oil industry publication, reported that gasoline prices at full-service stations rose about 2 cents a gallon nationwide since February. That is nearly twice the rise from January to February.

A gallon of unleaded gasoline in Chicago, for example, increased from 82.19 cents to 84.36 cents.

The Lundberg Letter attributed the rise to the Iranian oil production slowdown and the Energy Department's decision earlier this month to let oil companies pass through refining costs on certain gasolines.

Nigeria supplies about 6.1 percent of the 18.7 million barrels of oil used daily by the United States — an import figure exceeded only by Saudi Arabia.

The increase would be far larger than the 3.9 percent boost originally scheduled for April 1 by members of the Organization of Petroleum Exporting Countries. Moreover, it would nearly double price boosts already announced by OPEC nations reacting to tightened supplies caused by Iran's problems.

Analysts said Nigeria's new price by itself might not raise consumer prices, but if other oil producers match the boost, gasoline prices could rise by 3 cents a gallon.

OPEC had scheduled a total increase of 14.5 percent this year in the basic price of crude oil. The first increase, of 5 percent, raised the price to $13.35 Jan. 1. Other increases were scheduled quarterly.

Speculation abounded that OPEC nations would decide March 26 to set base prices at a level reflecting 9 percent increases announced by most countries recently.

But Nigeria's warning that it wants to raise the per-barrel price by $2.50 — from $14.80 to $17.30 — no matter what OPEC does, may alter other OPEC members' thinking, analysts said.

Dope arrest in court

Oakland—The district attorney's office said today that an Alameda County court reporter was arrested in a courtroom here as she allegedly attempted to pass a chunk of hashish to an armed robbery defendant.

Cassandra Warren, court reporter for Superior Court Judge Richard Bancroft, was booked Monday on drug-possession charges after a bailiff said he saw her slip a small package to Larry Freeman, on trial in Bancroft's court.

Deputy District Attorney Richard Iglehart said the oily substance in the package was taken to the crime lab, where it was found to be "very good hashish"—a resinous extract of marijuana.

Iglehart said that when the bailiff confronted Warren and took the hashish, she told him: "You've never busted me for smoking marijuana."

When the bailiff sniffed the package, according to Iglehart, Warren said: "It's hash, you dummy."

Iglehart said there apparently was "some relationship" between Warren and defendant Freeman, but he was uncertain what it was.

Judge Bancroft said he had no idea she knew the defendant when his trial began and she was assigned to transcribe the testimony in it. Another reporter has now been assigned to Bancroft's courtroom.

Warren, who could not be reached for comment, reportedly told an acquaintance the hashish was found near her work area in the courtroom and she didn't know how it got there.

Sadat says 'real test' lies in future

Associated Press

Mit Abul Kout, Egypt—President Anwar Sadat, celebrating what he called "the victory of peace" in his home village, declared today that the "real test" of the peace process will come after the signing of an Egyptian-Israeli treaty.

The Egyptian leader also said he wanted to hold a triple-signing ceremony in Washington because "it is Carter's show."

At an impromtu news conference at the graveside of his younger brother, a pilot killed in the 1973 Mideast war, Sadat spoke of negotiations that will follow the treaty signing on details of establishing self-rule for the Palestinians in the Israeli-occupied territories.

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Tomorrow's weather

Near the Bay
Fair, continued cool

Eastbay Valleys
Fair, continued cool

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